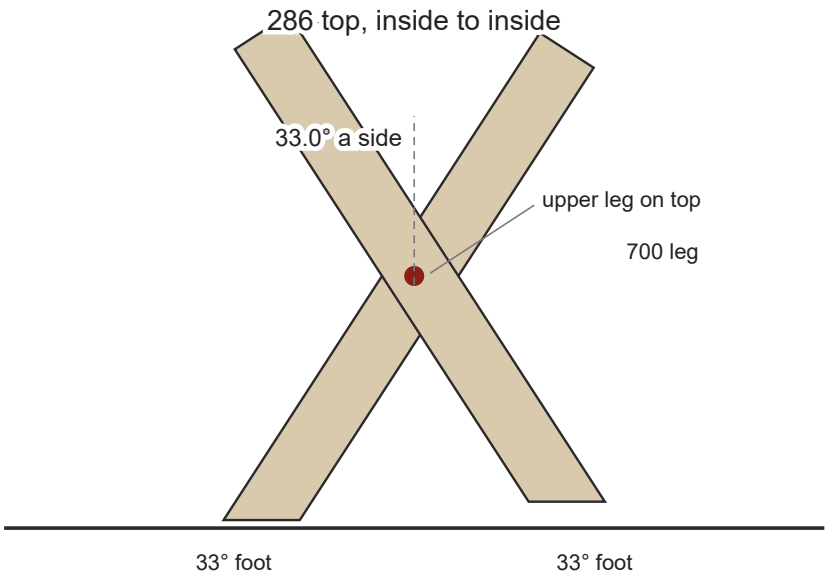
X-Leg Herb Trough your build · v6

- Your numbers. Two X-leg frames carry a 900 long trough between them.
- Legs **4×700**, one end cut 33°. Cross planks **8×900**, four front and four back. Planks 80 wide × 23 thick.
- **The X is set by the top.** With 700 mm legs at 33°, the top inside gap is **about 286 mm**. Use the same gap on both frames.
- The two legs do not notch: the upper leg lies straight **on top of** the lower one, so there is an inside leg and an outside leg.
- The pieces that close the ends are not cut to a number. They **lie inside the V of the legs** and are **scribed off an offcut**, one on top of the last.
- Shown at 900 long, four planks deep. Dimensions in mm.

X JOINT - stage 1



Stage 1 - the joint that decides the box. Two 700 mm legs crossed at their centres, upper leg lying on the lower. Keep the feet flush on the clamped plank and the top inside gap at 286 mm so both frames match.

CUT LIST

PART	QTY	LENGTH	WIDTH	THICK	NOTE
Leg	4	700	80	23	one end cut 33°, all four one setting
Cross plank (wall)	8	900	80	23	4 front, 4 back
Side piece	6	scribed	80	23	3 per end, marked off an offcut
- of those, the bottom pair	2	900	80	23	first plank's inner long edge cut 22.5° into the V; second trimmed 23 mm

MATERIAL

- Untreated pine or hardwood. Untreated: it is a food bed.
- **35 mm part-threaded screws** for the crossing and the side courses.
- A **6 mm or 10 mm bolt** through each crossing if you want it to never move.
- Stainless or coated only. Wood oil (Woodoc) outside and on the feet.

Two rules that decide this build

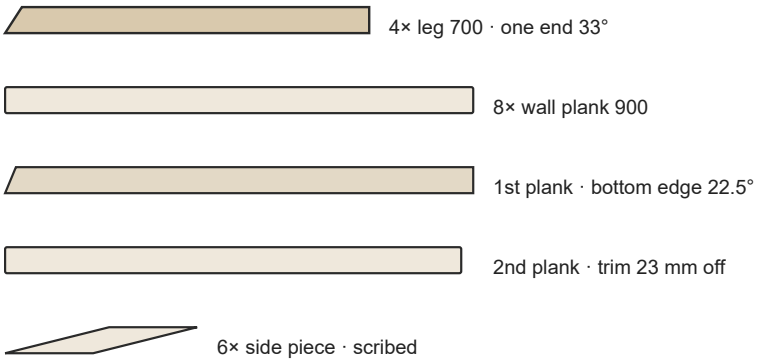
- **One saw setting for all four feet.** Cut every 33° end off the same stop. One foot cut on its own and the box stands on three legs.
- **Lock the crossing.** A single screw lets the X scissor. Add 3-4 screws, or bolt it.

Locked in from your build photos (14 Oct)

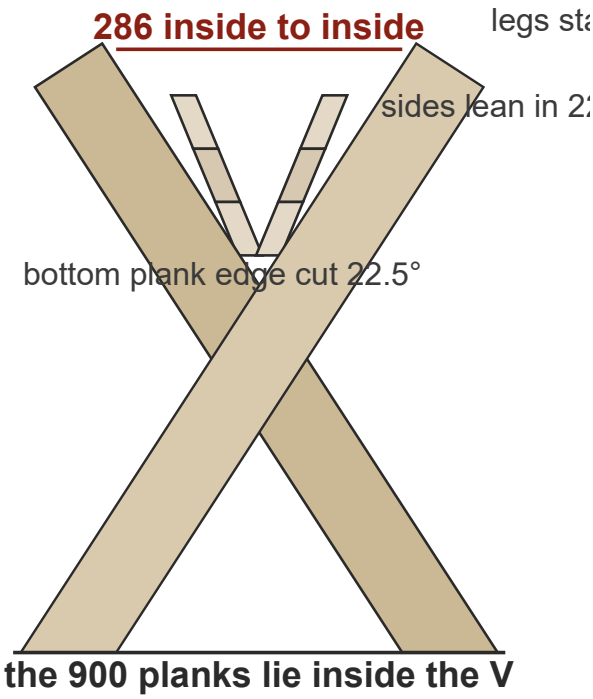
- **Top gap = about 286 mm, inside corner to inside corner.** Use the same gauge for both X frames.
- **Feet cut at 33°** so they sit flat. Method: clamp a plank, leg flush, one centre screw into the middle of the plank.
- **The two legs cross one on top of the other.** No notch - the upper leg lies full-thickness on the lower, so there is an inside leg and an outside leg.
- **Spacer blocks at the shoulder.** Small blocks fill the gap between the angled leg head and the underside of the first planks. Drawn from the ~60 and ~75 mm marks in your shots.
- **One wall flush, one proud.** The back planks run **flush to the outside leg**; the front planks stand **23 mm proud** (one plank thickness), as in your shots.

Cut list, drawn what to cut

Every cut in the build. Two angles hold the whole thing: **33°** on the leg, **22.5°** in the V, and the rest square.



WHERE THE PLANKS SIT



End view: the pieces lie inside the V of the legs. The trough is not a tray sitting on top - it drops down inside the X, both long sides leaning in at 22.5° to a narrow bottom, and the leg tops stand proud above the rim. The lowest plank's bottom edge is cut at 22.5° so it sits level; the next lands one thickness (23 mm) higher, so trim 23 mm off its edge and the tops come level.

The two angles that fool everyone

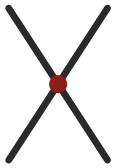
- 33° is the **leg** - the foot cut and the lean, one saw setting. Nothing else is 33°.
- 22.5° is the **V** - how far each side leans in, and the cut on the lowest plank's bottom edge to match it.
- Each side above that is **scribed** off an offcut stood in the V, not set to a number.

The build in four stages

picture sequence

Four stages, in order. Do not start the sides until the walls are screwed down and level.

1

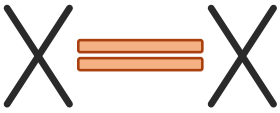


33° feet · screw the centre

Stage 1 - make two X frames. There are four legs altogether: cross two legs to make one X at each end. Cut one end of each leg at 33°. Centre the joint 350 mm along and 40 mm across each leg. Put one leg on top of the other, drill a pilot hole and fit the centre screw. Match both X frames.

Check: the feet sit flat and both frames have the same 286 mm inside top gap.

2



first two in the V

Stage 2 - stand the frames and fit the first long planks. Stand the two X frames parallel, 900 mm apart. Fit one 900 mm plank along the inside of each V, one on the front and one on the back. Bevel the first plank's inner long edge to fit the V. Trim 23 mm from the second plank's edge so the first two plank tops are level.

Check: both starter planks sit snug in the Vs and level with each other.

3



4 front + 4 back

Stage 3 - build up the long sides. Add the remaining planks between the two X frames: three above the starter plank on each side, four courses total on the front and four on the back. Fix them to the inside faces of the X-frame legs. Keep the back planks flush with the outside legs; the front planks stand 23 mm proud.

Check: both long sides finish level before you close the ends.

4



sides off an offcut

Stage 4 - close the two ends. Hold an offcut in the V at one end and mark the first end piece. Cut and fit it. Use each fitted piece to mark the next one; glue and screw three pieces in place. Repeat at the other end.

Check: all six end pieces fit inside the Vs, three at each end.

Stage by stage 1 – 2

#	STAGE	WHY
1	**Make the two X frames.** • Use four legs, each 700 mm long. Cut one end of each at 33°, using the same saw setting. • Mark the crossing point at the centre of each leg: 350 mm along and 40 mm across. • Clamp a straight plank to the table. Press the angled foot of the first leg flush against it. • Place a second leg on top to make an X. Drill a pilot hole at the crossing. • Fit a 35 mm part-threaded screw through the crossing. Add 3-4 screws or use a 6 mm or 10 mm bolt. • Set the top inside gap to 286 mm. Repeat for the second X frame.	• One saw setting for all four feet = feet that sit level. Cut them one at a time and they fight. • The clamped plank is the reference - it stops the X leaning while you screw. • There are two legs in each X. They do not notch; one lies full-thickness on top of the other. • A single screw lets the X scissor. Extra screws or a bolt lock the crossing. • Make the second X frame the same as the first so the trough sits level.
2	**Stand the frames and fit the first long planks.** • Stand the two X frames parallel, one at each end of the trough. • Fit one 900 mm plank along the inside of each V: one on the front and one on the back. These are the first planks of the long sides, not a flat floor. • Cut the first plank's **inner long edge** to the confirmed angle so it sits snug in the V. • The second plank sits 23 mm higher. Trim 23 mm from its edge so the two starter plank tops line up.	• Parallel X frames support the long planks at both ends. • The bevel lets the plank sit snug against the inside of the V. • Level starter planks give the remaining courses a level start.

Stage by stage 3 – 4

#	STAGE	WHY
3	**Fix the remaining planks to make the long sides.** • Add three planks above the starter plank on each side: four courses total on the front and four on the back. • Fix the planks along the **inside faces of the X-frame legs**. The planks run between the frames; they do not sit on top of the leg ends. • Keep the plank ends lined up. The back planks are flush with the outside legs; the front planks stand 23 mm proud. • Keep both long sides at the same height and screw the planks to both X frames.	• The two X frames are the end supports; the 900 mm planks connect them to make the long sides. • The front/back offset clears the legs and follows the original build arrangement. • Matching heights give a level rim.
4	**Close the ends with scribed planks.** • Hold an offcut horizontally at the bottom of the V. Mark the angle from the inside to make the first end piece. • Cut along the mark and fit the piece inside the V. • Use a longer offcut to mark the next piece above the first. Cut it, glue it and screw it on top. • Mark and fit a third piece above the second. Repeat all three pieces at the other end.	• Each end piece is marked from the actual V, rather than cut to a guessed angle. • Glue **and** screw: end grain is weak, the glue takes the load, the screws hold it while it sets. • Three pieces close each end from the bottom to the rim.